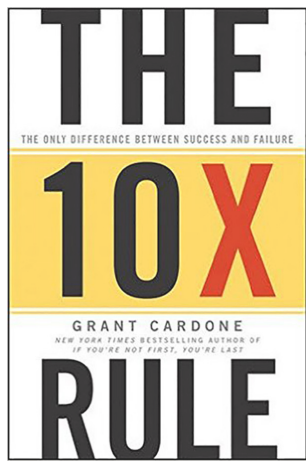




THE 10X RULE

The Only Difference between
Success and Failure

GRANT CARDONE

The Big “So What”



The 10X Rule is the single most important principle or ingredient needed to achieve extraordinary results. This book explains how you can use big thinking and massive actions to create unstoppable momentum for phenomenal success.

Introduction



This book is written for people who want to achieve colossal success and are not afraid to take the actions to achieve it. It's *not* for those who want comfort or are satisfied with average results.

Most of us fail to achieve our goals because:



We set sub-par goals that are too low or not motivating enough.

- In reality, our perceptions of what's “good”, “ethical”, “rich”, “hardworking” etc. are largely influenced by societal norms. We may not even realize that these are not our own standards.
- Instead of creating breakthroughs, we end up competing on existing levels. Worse, we set low standards to avoid disappointment, or lie to ourselves that certain goals are unimportant if we fail to achieve them.



We underestimate the amount of challenges we must overcome, as well as the amount of effort/resources needed to achieve our goals.

- Success is not a single event, but an accumulation of many activities and milestones that jointly create our desired

KEY QUOTES

“Regardless of how you define success, this book will show you how to guarantee the attainment of it—with any dream and in any economy.”

“Success...is an accumulation of events turning out well or desired outcomes being achieved.”

outcomes. When we go for overnight success or get-rich-quick schemes, we grossly underestimate what it takes to succeed and therefore fail.

- As a result, we get disappointed, discouraged, and start finding excuses to quit or shift our goal-posts.

The key to success is to prepare yourself mentally for the actual amount of work needed *and* build in the buffers for unplanned variables that'll crop up. Achieving success is a never-ending process. People who are extraordinarily successful never stop seeking higher levels of accomplishments. They know that once they become complacent, they will slow down and eventually slide backward.

The 10X Rule Behind Massive Success



The 10X Rule says that you can only achieve phenomenal success if you upsize your thinking and action to 10 times that of others', i.e. set targets that are 10X bigger and take 10X the amount of action. This single discipline will make the biggest difference between massive success and failure.

Defining Success



Fundamentally, success is about attaining your desired outcomes. It's subjective as each of us define success differently and have varying goals at different points in our lives. A student may define success as popularity or good academic results, a young adult may define success as a promotion or owning his/her own apartment, while a retiree may define success in terms of health, legacy and meaningful relationships.

Regardless of how you define success, it's vital that you start with a *desire* to achieve it.



Success is important for the survival of any individual, group or community, as it provides confidence, security, a sense of purpose and identity.



It's your duty and responsibility to fulfill your potential. Don't wait for success to come knocking or hope for lucky breaks. Take concrete actions to define, seek and create your own success.

KEY QUOTES

"It is better to be pleasantly surprised than greatly disappointed."

"Success is...like a breath of air; although your last breath of air is important, it's not nearly as important as the next one."

"You must set targets that are 10 times what you think you want and then do 10 times what you think it will take to accomplish those targets. Massive thoughts must be followed by massive actions."

"Success is the degree or measure of attaining some desired object or end."

"Success is not something that happens to you; it's something that happens because of you and because of the actions you take."

∞ Success is unlimited. It's not a finite product to be acquired, nor does it deplete with use. It's something you *create*, and there are infinite ways to create success, through new innovations, ideas, solutions etc. It's not true that others have to lose in order for you to win. Others' successes won't reduce your chances for success and can even create opportunities for you.

Taking 10X Actions



Generally, there are 4 levels of action that all of us use at some point in our lives. However, most of the time, most people only use the first 3 levels of action. **Normal levels of activity deliver at most normal results; you need extraordinary levels of activity for extraordinary results.**



⊘ Level 1: Doing nothing. People in this group feel bored and aimless. They spend their time and energy finding excuses or engaging in unproductive activities like gaming or watching movies.

🏃 Level 2: Retreat. People in this group play it safe; they're afraid of rejection or failure due to their upbringing or past experiences. They justify their actions (or lack of action) as the way to survive.

▲ Level 3: Normal amount of action, i.e. simply doing what's widely acceptable, not what's truly needed to achieve your goals. This is the most common and also the most dangerous level, as it results in widespread mediocrity.

🏃 Level 4: Massive action. People in this group are insanely driven. They don't monitor their work hours and simply do whatever it takes to achieve their goals. You know you're entering this zone when:

KEY QUOTES

"Success is not a zero sum game, there can be many winners."

"Money and power follow attention, so whoever can get the most attention is the person who takes the most action and sooner or later will get the most results."

"Remember: If you don't create new problems, then you're not taking enough action."

- Your massive actions start to create new problems (which drive you to take even more action to address them); and
- You start to get criticisms, negative labels and warnings from others, telling you that you're crazy, off-balance etc. Keep going—you'll eventually get the attention and results you seek, and these criticisms will turn to praise/admiration.

Setting 10X Goals



Being “average” is a formula for failure. You don't gain enough momentum for real success and tend to lose what you have during bad times.

- People in the middle class (those earning about US\$22,000-65,000 annually as of 2008) may enjoy some comfort during good times, but struggle with job/income loss and debts during bad times. They do enough to get by, but not enough to enjoy real success, security or fulfillment.
- Top earners make 319 times more money than average people. Those who complain that this is unfair fail to consider the fact that top earners also take significantly *more action* to develop skills, connections etc.
- The average person reads less than 1 book a year, while the top US CEOs averagely read more than 60 books a year. During the 2008 economic downturn, Starbucks' founder Howard Schultz cut expenses, closed down under-performing stores, *and* travelled around the country to personally meet with customers for feedback. Schultz took massive action despite already being a billionaire, or perhaps he became a billionaire precisely because he had been taking massive action.



The only way to win big is to set ambitious, 10X goals.

- Small or realistic goals that you look at once a year cannot inspire the big thinking needed for massive action.
- Ensure that your goals are (a) big and exciting and (b) aligned with your purpose, so you'll feel motivated to think and act on them *every day*. Benchmark your goals minimally against

KEY QUOTES

“Average never yields anything more than average and usually much less.”

“There are no shortcuts. The more action you take, the better your chances are of getting a break.”

“Realistic thinking is based on what others think is possible—but they are not you and have no way of knowing your potential and purposes.”

the top players in the field. If you're willing to take 10X actions, you can achieve any goal, no matter how ambitious.

- Cardone's 10X goals include: "I own 5000+ apartments that return over 12 percent positive cash flow", "my marriage is alive and healthy and a positive model for others", and "I have written 12 or more best-selling books."

Components/Principles behind the 10X Rule



Take control of your life. Accept that *everything* that happens—be it good or bad—is a result of what you do and don't do.

- When you blame other people or circumstances for what happens to you, you're essentially giving up control of your life and adopting a victim mindset.
- There's always something you can do to improve your situation, and lessons you can learn to avoid repeating the same mistakes. When things go wrong, rather than blame external factors, ask yourself, "What can I do to ensure this doesn't happen again?" Push yourself to find the untapped strengths, resources and potential that you can call upon to create your desired outcomes.
- All of us make excuses for things that we do or don't do. Write down all your excuses, e.g. I have no money, I have no time, I'm too young/old, the economy is bad etc. You can only improve your situation if you get past your excuses to deal with the real reasons behind them. For example, being late due to traffic is merely an excuse; the true reason you're late is because you didn't leave early enough to cater for traffic.



Don't compete. Dominate. When you focus on competing, you waste energy chasing after your rivals. Aim to dominate your sector, i.e. be amongst the top in your industry, and ideally dominate the sector so completely that you're the *only one* in consumers' minds. Set the pace/trend and let others try to copy you instead.

KEY QUOTES

"Nothing happens to you; it happens because of you."

"Excuses are...just a revision of the facts that you make up in order to help yourself feel better about what happened."

"Making excuses won't change your situation; only getting to the real reason behind it can do this."

- It's ok to study best practices and learn from others, but go beyond existing practices to play at a different level. Hammer away at your competitors' specialties until they become *your* unique advantage. You'll need a lot of activity to penetrate a sector, and even more activity to dominate a sector.
- Ask yourself: what are the unreasonable things that only you would do? Do what others won't do, go where they won't go, and take so much action that no one can catch up with you. For example, one of Cardone's clients decided to call customers just before they left the carpark and give them a special counter-offer. By doing what their competitors didn't or wouldn't do, they managed to convert a large number of potential customers they would otherwise have lost.



Build omnipresence. You can add value by helping one person, **but you become truly phenomenal when millions or billions of people know you and need your services regularly.**

- Your name is your most vital asset. Your goal is to have people see you so often that they think of you all the time, and immediately associate your name/face/logo with your sector and what you stand for.
- Aim for a global footprint and to become a household name like Coca-Cola, Google, Starbucks, McDonald's, or Visa. Such a mindset will fundamentally change how you think and act, and you'll find yourself taking extreme measures and saying "yes" to opportunities.



Get obsessed with your big dream and let it dominate your thoughts and feelings.

- Think daily about what you must do to dominate your sector and take action persistently until you succeed. It's better to be obsessed with your goal than with your excuses.
- Obsessive people get labeled as crazy or off-balance. Yet, once they achieve their breakthroughs, they're suddenly regarded as geniuses and revolutionaries. Treat obsession as an essential ingredient for success, rather than the exception to the norm.

KEY QUOTES

"Market conditions won't improve until you improve the way you think and approach the market."

"Forward thinkers don't copy. They don't compete—they create."

"It is impossible to amass true success without thinking in terms of making your ideas, products, services or brand universal."

"The higher your purpose, the more fuel it will provide for your 10X actions. This is what it takes to rocket to omnipresence."

"The way to approach a sector, goal, or any endeavor (is) to own it completely."

"What if the only thing standing in the way of your greatness was that you just had to go after everything obsessively, persistently, and as though your life depended on it?"



Go all-in. In poker, this means placing all your chips on a bet. In the case of your goals, it means **putting in 100% of your effort, energy, focus, persistence and creativity toward achieving success.**

- The good news is, there's no limit to your energy, creativity or persistence. So, you can go all-in over and over again until you succeed.
- People are likely to warn you not to overexpose yourself. The 10X Rule says the opposite—overcommit so you have no choice but to keep pushing ahead until you reach your goals. For example, if you're in sales, don't just aim to reach a sales target; overcommit to every step of the sales process, including your number of appointments, marketing materials, pitches, follow ups etc. You will create new problems, e.g. have more appointments than you can fit into your calendar. However, as you tackle the problems, you'd find yourself achieving much bigger results than you imagined possible.



Expand. Never contract. During bad times, people naturally cut back on expenses and activities, i.e. they retreat. **Push yourself to continue with massive 10X action, so you expand while others contract.** Remember:

- Never follow the masses blindly, as they're usually wrong. By the time everyone is retreating, the market is usually already on the way to recovery.
- Expanding doesn't mean spending money recklessly. It's about putting in 10X the energy, creativity and resilience, all of which are abundant and won't run out.



Build massive momentum. When you start to see results, do not slow down or stop. Keep going by adding new ideas and activity until you're unstoppable.

- It's like adding fuel (efforts, ideas and creative resources) to your fire until it becomes a raging forest fire. On the other hand, If you stop feeding your fire, it will gradually be reduced to ember or ashes.

KEY QUOTES

"Devoting yourself to something all the way means that there's no backing out."

"One of the major differences between successful and unsuccessful people is that the former look for problems to resolve, whereas the latter make every attempt to avoid them."

"You never want to blindly follow the masses; they are almost always wrong."

"Your fire has to continue to be stoked, and that means more wood, more fuel, and in your case, more actions."

"Keep adding wood until the fire is burning so hot that no one—and nothing—can put out your success."

- As you push ahead, you'll encounter new challenges that'd fire you up. Stay in level 4 action and address each wave of challenges as they come. When you move at this pace, none of your competitors can keep up even if they try to duplicate your efforts.



Do what you fear. Fear is an emotion triggered by what we *think* may happen. In other words, fear is unreal and most of our fears are never realized.

- Instead of treating fear as a sign to retreat, treat it as a sign to take action and do what others refuse to do. If you fear rejection from a client, it means you must approach the client; if you fear public speaking, it means you must take on a speaking engagement.
- The best way to tackle fear is to take action immediately, so your fear has no time or chance to grow. **When you use fear to fuel your actions, it makes you appear fearless and gives you huge momentum.**



Don't manage time. Optimize it. It doesn't make sense to try to manage time if you don't know how much time you have, or how long you need to accomplish something. Instead, **aim to get the most value from your time: know how you're using your time, direct most of your time toward your priorities, and squeeze the most out of every second.**

- Start a time-log to become aware of how you're currently using your time.
- Then, calculate how much time you have and what you must achieve with your available time. For example, if you're 40 years old, believe you'll live till 80 and want to make \$10mil, then you have at most 350,400 hours left to generate \$10mil. Or, if you want to make \$10,000 a month with 40 hours a week, then you must ensure every hour of work is worth \$62.50.
- Rather than drag yourself to work, plan your day in advance and make it a game to see how much more you can achieve. For example, you can challenge yourself to make \$100 an hour instead of \$10 an hour, or redirect 5 more hours a week for quality time with your kids. When you increase the value you get from every second, you're effectively multiplying your time.

KEY QUOTES

"Fear is actually a sign that you are doing what's needed to move in the right direction."

"Starve the fear of its favorite food by removing time from its menu."

"Most people have no clue what they are doing with their time but still complain that they don't have enough."

"If you don't manage your time, I promise that you will waste it."



Expect criticism. Your massive actions and results will attract both admiration and envy/jealousy. People may criticize you for spending too much time on work, making the wrong decisions, taking too much risk etc.

- Expect criticism so it won't overwhelm you. See it as a sign of success and keep moving with 10X actions. With enough success, the people who initially criticized you will eventually start to admire you.
- Don't try to stay under the radar to avoid being noticed and attacked by competitors. To become a market leader and dominate your sector, you *must* get noticed.



Go for market share, not customer satisfaction. Most companies fail not because of an inferior product, but because they don't get enough customers. There's no point in worrying about customer satisfaction if you can't acquire them in the first place. **Focus on expanding your market share—this pushes you to attract customers, get them to use/pay for your solutions and stay with you.** The larger your customer base, the higher your chances of finding quality customers to focus on.

- Your first priority should be to acquire customers: get their attention and impress them with a great solution.
- Then, use the complaints/problems from existing customers to identify areas for improvement—when you solve your clients' problems, it builds loyalty and generates word-of-mouth publicity. Concurrently get feedback from people that you do not acquire, to identify the gaps or issues in your buying process.
- In short, expanding your footprint is a more meaningful goal as it forces you to tackle the entire value chain from product to processes and promotions, which ultimately deliver customer satisfaction.

KEY QUOTES

"Some will admire you, some will want to learn from you, but unfortunately, most will envy you."

"Criticism is not something that you want to avoid; rather, it's what you must expect to come your way once you start hitting it big."

"Customer acquisition is the primary target, followed by customer loyalty, followed by customers who spread the word about you."

Winning Big in Life



Ingredients for Success



The difference between successful and unsuccessful people lies not in their background or circumstances, but with the way they think, talk and act. Cardone breaks this down into 32 traits/habits, which we've condensed into 8 key principles below:

 **Have a “Can Do” attitude.** Look for opportunities, possibilities and solutions in any situation. Even if you don't have a ready answer, have the faith and willingness to take action anyway, and figure things out along the way.

 **Embrace challenges, fear and discomfort.** Courage is about acting in spite of fear. You can't create breakthroughs without changes, so you must try new things and take bold actions even if they make you extremely uncomfortable. Use challenges to sharpen and stimulate your growth. Realize that the bigger the problems you solve, the bigger the rewards.

 **Dare to be unreasonable.** Our so-called practical realities are merely artificial limits—electricity, air travel, and the internet were all considered impossible until someone made them real. Even the most cautious people will suffer losses and mistakes, so you might as well take risks, knowing you can always try again if you fail.

 **Aim to create wealth,** not just earn money. True wealth is created via the exchange of new ideas and solutions, and you can create unlimited wealth through creative solutions to universal problems. When you help others in your team/community to succeed, it will also indirectly help you to succeed.

 **Commit and go all-in.** You have 100% control of the actions you take. Say “yes” to life and possibilities, take massive action now, and go all-in such that you have no option to quit or cut back.

KEY QUOTES

“The more you win in life, the higher your potential will be—and the more you will grow to love challenges.”

“Don't focus on how hard the work is but rather on how rewarding the results are!”

“Man would do nothing exceptional if it were not for the willingness to be unreasonable.”



Persist till the end. Have the discipline to do whatever you must until you achieve your goal. The more you persist, the more you develop your mental, emotional, and financial strengths, and build positive habits from your repeated activities.



Focus on goals and results. Don't focus on the amount of attempts or time spent, or get lost in mundane tasks. Focus on your goals, results and the wider mission to change/impact the world.



Grow yourself relentlessly. When you invest in knowledge and improve yourself, you can get the most from your efforts and multiply the results from your 10X actions. Surround yourself with people who're better educated, more connected and more successful than you. Keep pushing yourself to higher levels of action and achievements, so you fulfill your duty to live to your full potential.

Getting started with 10X



Cardone learned from personal experience how powerful the right mindset and level of actions can be.

- He had been playing it safe until he was attacked by people who didn't want him to succeed, and decided to take massive action. In 18 months, he recorded more than 200 videos, wrote 150 blog articles and did 700 radio interviews. Then, he generated TV exposure and put up thousands of social media posts.
- All these added up to give him massive exposure. As business flooded in, his footprint expanded further and he even got his own TV show. This huge success was the best revenge he could've had on those who tried to drag him down.



Start applying the 10X Rule by focusing on your big vision of the future but taking action in the now:

- Make an initial list of your 10X goals. At this point, don't reduce the size of your goals nor worry about how you'll achieve them yet.

KEY QUOTES

"Until an action is turned into a success, it is not done."

"Quit patting yourself on the back for trying, and save your rewards and accolades for actual accomplishment."

"Successful people assume that their future achievements rely on investing in actions that... when taken consistently and persistently over time will sooner or later bear fruit."

"The best payback possible...(is) simply amassing more success."

- List down the actions you can take by asking, “What actions can I take now to move me toward these goals?”
- Start taking action immediately, regardless of how you feel and don’t prematurely evaluate the outcome of your actions.
- Review and rewrite your goals daily when you wake up and before you go to sleep. Remember the points above, and keep pushing ahead toward your dreams and goals.

Other Details in the Book to Look out For



In the book, Cardone shares many of his personal observations and experiences about success. Each chapter also includes a short exercise to help you recap what you’ve learnt. For more details and resources, please visit grantcardone.com.

About the Author



Grant Cardone (born 1958) an American author, motivational speaker, real estate investor and sales trainer. He has worked with Fortune 100 companies such as Google, Wells Fargo, and Ford to customize sales processes and improve customer experience. He is also the owner of Whatever It Takes Network, a digital network where he hosts, directs, and produces programs that help people do whatever it takes to create success in their lives.

KEY QUOTES